



## Apple Pay in China

Apple pay goes live in China, making it the fifth country worldwide accepting Apple's digital payments <http://dgit.in/iPayChina>



## Secure your Instagram

Long overdue, Instagram finally adds two-factor authentication to combat hackers <http://dgit.in/Insta2FactA>

**Budget smartphones**

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One of the most common questions we get nowadays goes something like this: "I have a budget of ₹10,000, suggest the best phone in this budget. I want to play games, it must have a good camera and the best performance". It tells us that a majority of phone buyers are not looking for a premium smartphone, or the best phone in the market but, for something in a budget that can still provide a good experience.

Thankfully, developments in the smartphone market have led to budget smartphones doing much more than they used to a couple of years ago. Features like 3GB of RAM is new, but it's quickly becoming an imperative for this segment. So, when it's power and efficiency you want, these are the phones that you should go for.

Companies launch new phones by the dozen today though, which means there's a lot to choose from, even in this difficult category. An important category where most of the emerging smartphone consumption demand is situated currently. Don't you worry, we're always here to help you out and make the buying decision simpler. Here is what eight of the best in this price range look like, when they're pitted against each other.

## COOLPAD NOTE 3 LITE

The Coolpad Note 3 Lite is the most affordable smartphone in this shootout. While it may not be the overall best performing smartphone in the sub-10K category, it is definitely the one to buy in the sub-7K price bracket. At its stellar price of ₹6,999,

the phone is able to offer 3GB of RAM, but it is also the first phone in the sub-7K range to boast a fingerprint sensor and hence sets a new benchmark for budget smartphones. The phone feels robust in the hand, thanks to bi-metallic frame.

In terms of performance, the MediaTek chipset delivers acceptable performance in terms of multitasking, gaming and all the other regular tasks. You can, for instance, easily stream audio online, stay connected to Wi-Fi, update applications in the background and play reasonably intensive games, without a hint of a stutter. The phone also keeps the battery life in check. It can last around 8 hours on a single charge on our battery test, although it can do more than that on regular usage. It is the best buy amongst the phones

in this comparison by a good margin, no doubt.

The 13MP rear camera however, isn't that great and leaves us wanting for more. Image quality is average but video recording is certainly good. The camera app has useful features such as filter and a Pro mode. All things considered, this phone definitely does its bit to distinguish itself from the rest of the bunch.

## INTEX CLOUD SWIFT

The Intex Cloud Swift is one of the more disappointing smartphones in this comparison. It is not very good looking and the build quality isn't that great either. While the plastic build should work in the ₹7.5K price range, this phone still looks quite cheap for its price. The Cloud Swift has a decent display though, and the 720p

IPS LCD panel provides decent colour saturation along with good viewing angles. However, it still lacks the overall quality of the Coolpad Note 3 Lite.

What's more disappointing is that the phone's performance isn't great either. The 1.3GHz quad-core Mediatek SoC on this device delivered the lowest score on synthetic benchmarks, during our tests. Even on real life performance, the phone seems quite average at best, and the UI is less than welcoming. For example, while there are on-screen navigation keys, the recents button actually opens 'options', while there is an extra capacitive screen that acts as both home and recents. Long pressing the capacitive button opens recents, while the regular recents button for some reason opens Options.

## HOW WE TESTED

### Performance and battery tests

Synthetic benchmarks aren't always the best reflection of how a device performs in real life, but they are the first step to find how competent these phones are and to compare them against their peers. Benchmarks also provide a comparative score with phones that haven't been included in this comparison, which gives us even better insight. Of course, we don't depend on them alone, but you get the point.

To test the battery life of the phones, we used the standard Geekbench battery test. After charging the phones to 100 percent, displays of all smartphones were turned to full brightness. After that, we simply started the battery benchmark and let it run till the battery died. There's also a looping video test that we use, and together, these two gives us a really good idea of the battery life, which is then justified by real world usage.

### Real life tests

To test the real world performance, we devised tests, ranging from gaming to regular simpler apps, testing them out on the phones side by side. The fact that they have 3GB of RAM means that multitasking

should be a breeze for them. So, we tried playing multiple games on the phones, simultaneously, checking how long it took them to give up.

### Camera test

We conducted our camera tests in various of light conditions — dawn, daylight, overcast, studio (fluorescent), tungsten, night, low light and flash. Video recording tests were done out of fast moving vehicles, of fast-moving objects from a stationary point, still objects, and low light situations to test noise levels and frame interpolation in the recorded videos. We also tested the phones on aspects like shutter speeds and focusing times.

### Design and Usability

The eight contesting phones were judged on the following parameters — Looks, build quality of the phone, build quality of the display, interface design, and ergonomics. Even though these are just budget phones, build quality is given much importance.

The competitors in this test were — Intex Aqua Ace, Intex Cloud Swift, Xolo Black 1X, Lava X10, Coolpad Note 3, Coolpad Note 3 Lite, Kult 10 and Micromax Canvas Pulse 4G.